

Open source is licensing

Open source is about giving your users autonomy over how they want to use your software, and licensing provides just that. What's great about an open source licence is that regardless of what you as a maintainer do, all your end users and stakeholders can always maintain a certain set of forks, which are important forks.

Licensing gives people the option to take the project into a different direction if they deem it fit. They have the right to create a fork, which results in a lot of amazing software being developed. Maintainers have more responsibility to listen to their community members and to run the project in a way that works for them.

It's advisable to make use of the many licences available instead of setting your own terms separately,

simply because stakeholders and users are usually familiar with commonly used licences, so you do not have to waste time explaining them. This also helps you to focus your energy on the other parts of the project.

Finally, open source is a movement

Open source involves many, many dimensions and people. Most importantly, it is about understanding what these people want and creating an environment that encourages

collaboration and transparency. It is about building communities that help to build the open source project the way they want it to be. The more opportunity maintainers create to let them do that, the better the product is and the more successful it gets.

Open source is all of these things and the more expansive view you take, the better you can leverage it. Think about how you can excel in every dimension of open source because, at the end of the day, there is no easy path to open source success. **END** 🐧

 By: Jules Graybill

The author is director, Search Services, Amazon Web Services. This article is based on the talk 'The Easy Path To Open Source Success Doesn't Exist' that he gave at Open Source India 2021.

Transcribed and curated by: Siddha Dhar

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The Editor, D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi-110020.

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